PARTNER ONE-PAGER

Make it easy to refer me

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What I do (one line)

When a founder has hired good people and decisions still come back to them, I find out why. Then we change what's causing it and check over 30 days whether the handoff actually works.

When to think of me

A founder or CEO hired a COO, a Head of Ops, a GM or a senior lead **so the company would depend less on them**, and it still depends on them.

- Decisions the new leader was hired to own still land on the founder's desk.
- The team waits for the founder's yes on things that aren't the founder's call anymore.
- The founder takes a week off and things slow down.
- The founder is starting to wonder whether they hired the wrong person.

That last one is the best moment to introduce me: **before anyone gets fired.** Sometimes it is the wrong hire. Often it's the right person in a setup where they can't really own anything. I don't assume which. Finding out is the work.

It counts before the hire too. If a founder is betting that "once the Head of Ops is in, this stops," that's worth a look before the bet is placed.

Who it's for

Founder-led companies with customers and a team, usually 10 to 150 people, where the founder can actually change how decisions are made once the cause is clear. Funding stage doesn't matter much. What matters is that the hire already happened (or is about to), and it didn't take the decisions with it.

The phrases to listen for

Real things founders have said, not invented copy:

- "Every important decision comes back to me."
- "We need to go from founder to system."
- "My team is slow" / "My team feels slow."
- "I thought doing more would fix it. It just made things worse."
- "I feel lost all the time, 24 hours isn't enough."

They don't need to say it exactly. The pattern is: **a reasonable fix already happened (usually a hire), and the decisions still find their way back to the founder.**

Who it's NOT for

- People without a live costly decision or authority to act on it
- People who find the problem *interesting* but not *expensive* (no urgency, no budget)
- Anyone shopping for motivation, done-for-you implementation, or a general advisor

Why the hire doesn't fix it on its own

The clearest referral moment isn't a first complaint, it's a *second* one. Someone around the founder already tried a reasonable fix — a new planning tool, a tighter weekly meeting, clearer roles, a senior hire, another attempt to delegate. It didn't hold. The next exception, priority call, or stalled handoff still lands back on the founder's desk, because a process can't carry authority nobody assigned, and a hire can't close priorities the founder keeps reopening.

Refer when all five are true:

- the founder or CEO runs an operating company with customers or a team;
- one consequential decision will shape the next 30–90 days;
- the current drift has a concrete cost in rework, reversal, delay or missed revenue;
- a reasonable first fix has already failed; and
- the founder has the authority and demonstrated ability to act on the finding.

Pass when the business is still an idea, the question is general, nobody can name the cost, or the founder expects someone else to do the implementation for them.

How to introduce me

The forwardable line:

> "They hired good people and they're still in the middle of everything. Talk to my friend Trung before anyone gets fired. He works out why decisions keep coming back to the founder, and whether the fix is the person or the setup: linkedin.com/in/ctn1991. DM him 'diagnostic' to start."

Or just send them my LinkedIn (linkedin.com/in/ctn1991) and tell them to DM `diagnostic`. They'll figure out if it's relevant.

Or skip the pitch and just forward the essay: I hired someone. Why is the problem still on my desk?. If it lands, they'll ask who wrote it.

The more general version still works for founders who don't fit the hiring picture:

> "My friend Trung finds what's actually slowing early startup teams. 90-min session, and you walk out knowing what to stop scaling around. If that sounds like someone you know: linkedin.com/in/ctn1991. DM him 'diagnostic' to start."

One thing worth knowing about the relationship

Not every conversation ends in a diagnostic sale — and that's fine. When it's not the right fit, Trung says so directly and the relationship holds. People who don't buy now often come back months later, or refer someone who's a better fit. You won't burn a relationship by introducing someone: if it's not the right time, the conversation will be useful anyway and the door stays open.

What you get back

This goes both ways. Tell me who *your* ideal client is and what to listen for — I'll send them your way when I hear it. No fees, just trust running both directions.

Live version: iamtrung.com/d/partner-one-pager